CHURN IS DEAD

# The Work Ownership Decision Matrix

Give recurring customer work to the person who can make the binding decision.

Use this matrix for one recurring task that currently lands with a senior CSM. Separate the customer consequence from the binding decision, identify the person with authority, then choose whether CS should own, prepare, coordinate, or remove the work.

**Use:** Do not total the rows into an ownership score. Record the decision, the rightful owner, the CSM contribution, and the stop rule.

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SECTION 1

## Work and Customer Consequence

A task can matter deeply to the customer without belonging to the CSM.

| Record | Question | Evidence |
|---|---|---|
| Recurring work | What happens, how often, and what triggers it? | Workflow or recent example |
| Customer consequence | What changes for the customer if it is late, wrong, or absent? | Observed consequence |
| Required output | Is the output a decision, execution, evidence package, update, or handoff? | Named deliverable |
| End condition | What observable state means this occurrence is complete? | Completion test |

## Review This Section

**Decision prompt:** What customer decision or consequence makes this work necessary?

Record: _____

SECTION 2

## Authority and Capability Test

> Accountability without authority turns the CSM into a permanent escalation layer.

| Test | Record this | Ownership signal |
|---|---|---|
| Binding decision | The exact choice that must be made | Who has final authority? |
| Resources | Budget, backlog, technical access, policy, or people required | Who controls them? |
| Capability | Expert judgement or execution skill the work requires | Which function holds it? |
| Current mismatch | What is CS held responsible for but unable to decide? | Evidence of the gap |

## Review This Section

**Decision prompt:** Who can make the binding trade-off and control the resources required?

Record: _____

SECTION 3

## Ownership Mode Decision

A useful boundary specifies what CS still contributes instead of merely rejecting the work.

| Mode | Use when | Record the boundary |
|---|---|---|
| Own | CS can decide and the work requires customer judgement | Authority and outcome |
| Prepare | Another DRI decides; CS supplies evidence and recommendation | Input and answer date |
| Coordinate | A handoff needs temporary customer continuity | Owner, cadence, and stop rule |
| Remove | Work is repeated, automatable, duplicated, or non-durable | Process change and owner |

## Review This Section

**Decision prompt:** Should CS own, prepare, coordinate, or remove this work?

Record: _____

SECTION 4

## Handoff and Review Record

Reassignment fails when the new owner, decision date, and customer communication remain implicit.

| Record | Required detail | Owner/date |
|---|---|---|
| Rightful DRI | One person with final authority for the decision or execution | Name and function |
| CS contribution | Evidence, recommendation, context, or customer communication | Deliverable and date |
| Stop rule | Event after which CS coordination ends | Observable state |
| Review | Did the decision move and did the task return to CS? | Review date and action |

## Review This Section

**Decision prompt:** What changes at the next occurrence, and how will the team know the boundary held?

Record: _____

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# Ownership Change Record

| Record | Complete this |
|---|---|
| Recurring work and chosen mode | _____ |
| Rightful DRI and authority | _____ |
| CS contribution and due date | _____ |
| Stop rule and review date | _____ |

| CS mode | Use when | Required record |
|---|---|---|
| Own | CS has the authority, capability, and customer obligation to make the decision | Outcome, decision boundary, and review date |
| Prepare | Another function decides and CS contributes customer evidence or a recommendation | DRI, input package, and decision date |
| Coordinate | CS must preserve customer continuity across a time-bounded handoff | Operational owner, update cadence, escalation path, and stop rule |
| Remove | The work is repetitive, automatable, duplicative, or creates no durable improvement | Automation, process change, or activity to stop |

**What to do next:** Choose one task that recurs at least monthly. Complete the four sections, name the rightful DRI, and change the next occurrence before redesigning the entire role.